

Send SMSs from Your PC to a GSM Network

This article guides you on how to send SMSs to a GSM network with the help of software on your computer.



The SMS or short message service is used to send or receive text messages between users of mobile phones. The popularity of the service can be gauged by its extensive use. According to Wikipedia, "It is the most widely used data application in the world, with 3.5 billion active users, or 78 per cent of all mobile phone subscribers." Almost every mobile phone supports the SMS service, and sending an SMS from a mobile phone is quite simple. But have you ever thought about sending the SMS from your computer. It would be interesting to have an SMS application that is run from a laptop or PC.

PC to GSM communication

The underlying concept is based on controlling the GSM modem with the help of AT (ATtention) commands. Commands giving instructions are directed at the modem; the modem performs the job and returns the response to the command. These commands have originated in Hayes commands that used AT to indicate attention from the modem.

Standard AT commands are used to control GSM modems—commands specific to a GSM network are called extended AT commands. AT commands can be used for sending, reading and deleting SMSs, dialling numbers, checking signal strength and many other operations. To experiment with AT commands, you need to work with the GSM module, which consists of a GSM modem, communication interface and power supply. A mobile phone with a GSM modem can also be used. This article is based on experiments with AT commands on a Motorola L6i mobile phone. Different phones might not support all AT commands but a set of AT commands. While making PC-based SMS software, these commands need to communicate with the mobile phone via a serial or USB interface.

Preparing the set-up: To configure a PC-based solution that could send SMSs to a GSM network, you require a PC, a mobile phone with a built-in GSM modem, a SIM card, data cable and the driver for the mobile phone available on the phone vendor's website. First insert the SIM card in the mobile, and connect the mobile phone to your PC using the data cable